What Is Contemporary Art? ✕

Today's goal • 0/3 items
Complete 3 items today to stay at a good pace!

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Module 4
Materials & Making

Module 5
Agency

Visibility

✓ Introduction to Module 5
Reading • 10 min

✓ Pope.L's New York crawls
Reading • 10 min

✓ In New York City with Pope.L | Direct action
Video • 4 min

✓ Two artists consider Catherine Opie, Dyke, 1993
Video • 2 min

✓ Tania Bruguera on Untitled (Havana, 2000), 2000
Video • 4 min

✓ Luis Camnitzer on Memorial, 2009
Video • 2 min

✓ Yara Said on the Refugee Flag, 2016
Reading • 10 min

✓ Firelei Báez on For Améthyste and Athénaïre (Exiled Muses Beyond Jean Luc Nancy's Canon), Anacaonas, 2018
Reading • 10 min

Voice

○ **Who speaks?**
Reading • 10 min

○ Nick Cave on Soundsuit, 2011
Video • 2 min

○ Lawrence Abu Hamdan, Conflicted Phonemes, 2012
Reading • 10 min

○ P Staff on Weed Killer, 2017
Reading • 10 min

Action

○ Taking action
Reading • 10 min

○ Lorraine O'Grady on Mlle Bourgeoise Noire, 1980–83/2009
Video • 2 min

○ Xiao Lu on Dialogue, 1989
Video • 2 min

○ Ralph Borland, Suited for Subversion (Prototype), 2002
Video • 1 min

○ Defining and blurring identities through performance
Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond

○ Memory Check
Practice Assignment

○ Reflect on Agency in Module 5
Dialogue • 15 min

○ Optional Readings & Resources
Reading • 10 min

Module 6
Power

Exposing Power

○ Introduction to Module 6
Reading • 10 min

○ Instructor Christian Rattemeyer on Mark Lombardi's diagrams of power
Video • 6 min

○ What do war and peace have to do with chandeliers and portraits?
Reading • 10 min

○ Deana Lawson on Nation, 2017
Video • 2 min

Abuse of Power

○ How do artists critique power?
Reading • 10 min

○ Two responses to abuse of power
Reading • 10 min

○ Wolfgang Tillmans on Sendeschluss / End of Broadcast I, 2014
Video • 2 min

Sources of Power

○ Power: sources and resources
Reading • 10 min

○ Outer space to inner earth
Reading • 10 min

○ Curator Paola Antonelli on Massoud Hassani's Mine Kafon wind-powered deminer, 2011
Video • 1 min

○ Rania Ghosn on After Oil, 2016
Video • 4 min

Review & Respond

○ Memory Check
Practice Assignment

○ Reflecting on Power in Art
Dialogue • 15 min

○ Final course reflection
Graded Assignment • 30 min

○ Optional Readings & Resources
Reading • 10 min

○ End-of-course survey
Reading • 5 min

○ Recordings of live virtual sessions (optional)
Reading • 10 min

○ MoMA Resources
Reading • 10 min

Who speaks?

0:20 / 0:56 1x

From sight we move to sound. We'll hear from Nick Cave first, discussing the genesis of his Soundsuits. Named after the noises they generate when in motion, his Soundsuits make their wearers at once hyper-visible and anonymous, which for Cave reflects the position of members of society who are disproportionately targeted by law enforcement. "Sound…was my call for protest. It was a way of being heard," he says.

Sound, especially language and the voice, is the subject of Lawrence Abu Hamdan's work, so much so that he calls himself a "private ear." The work you'll learn about here is centered on the voices of a group of people seeking asylum in Amsterdam. Finally, we'll hear from Patrick Staff about *Weed Killer*, their adaptation of a memoir about undergoing chemotherapy into a video installation exploring the complexities of illness and treatment, including how it affects communication and connection.

Mark as completed

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